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these is completely eliminated. One may argue that it still promotes its own operations unabashedly, but does it do so 'solely', is the real question. Marketing innovation isn't a crime, stifling the competition by unfair means is. If Google runs its search engine in a manner to make money on Adwords / Adsense, where is the murder? If it wouldn't make profit out of its business, it may as well label itself as a vehicle of public good only.

By February 2014, Google's proposal had undergone two rounds of careful consideration and eventual rejections.



Pictured: A gentler version of CCI

However the third time showed promise to the extent that the EC made an official statement indicating a possible settlement. Unfortunately, the eighteen complainants weren't satisfied and the Commission decided to stay in the news.

The Commission decided that being in a dominant position, it is incumbent upon Google to treat its rivals fairly. As the biggest kid in class, you have to be nice to the puny ones. You can't throw them out of the window just because you can. In fact, you have to bolt the doors and windows to ensure the skinny ones don't fly out with the wind. That is the true mark of not being a bully. The Commission dismissed Google's third proposal as 'insufficient' to do so. One may wonder, why noticeable players such as Amazon and Ebay are conveniently being ignored as mighty adversaries of Google. This has been made to look like a situation where other companies in the same line of business can thrive only if Google decides to be a passive old gentleman. Slowly but surely Amazon is creeping up the ladder and market share. Google's representatives have used this argument along with more legal ones as an indication to the Commission that they are prepared to fight tooth and nail in order to do business

their way. Given this response, the Commission can now choose to immediately impose sanctions against Google and levy penalties capped at 10% of the company's annual global revenue. Of course seeking a fresh proposal may be a delightful way to extend this five year investigation by a couple of years more.

In return, Google reserves the right to appeal against any commission decision at EU courts which, just like our Indian judicial system, could take another 5 logo changes before a conclusion is reached.

The story here

In India, while the story is the same, there seems to be a bigger battle for Google brewing. Beginning in 2011, Indian companies have attacked Google saying that its Adwords policies are vague, and confusing. They believe that it is a conniving, evil corporation that invites certain companies over to its house and then sits and drinks with them while making plans to destroy the other companies, while at the same time possibly thinking about taking out the company sitting right in front of it. Possibly. While a minor case here and there has been dismissed, the one filed in 2011 by Bharat Matrimony, a matrimonial site you have definitely never wasted time on, and Consumer Unity & Trust Society, a non-profit organisation with a clear motive, stuck.

All of these complaints go to an agency called Competition Commission of India or CCI, the organisation which to a certain degree states that when you play football, you cannot build a goal smaller than the ball itself. Except this happens with companies. And here, boy is the CCI annoyed. When Google turned its head away and pretended not to hear, CCI took out its cane and whipped it with a fine of 1 crore rupees to show that it is serious.

Now, the CCI says that Google will have to pay a huge fine, of around \$6 billion, if it is found out that Google was being the quintessential evil corporation. While Google has said some things in its defence, it seems that it could be turning its head away again. After the period by which it was supposed to have defended itself passed, Google said "Hey CCI, I just remembered, I can't give you my answer till you give [secret documents which we will never know of] which will let me provide a better reply."

But what's next

This is roughly where the case stands at right now. Expect some more drama your way when Google says "Wait wait, THIS is what is happening here." To take a guess at what could possibly be the conclusion to this saga, one must wonder how to see this. Are all these countries simply putting pressure on a company because a company of this size cannot reach where it has without annoying somebody? Is America the gentle, forgiving English teacher, Europe the strict maths professor, and India the anal Hindi teacher who would not let you leave the class until you write down that paragraph to perfection? Or is Google the bald man sitting on an atrocious leather sofa stroking an exceptionally expensive looking but ugly cat?

Whatever it is, only one thing is for sure. However evil or unfair Google ends up looking in this whole saga, we will still not migrate to Bing. Ever. 